

WORLD DRONE CUP

2026



VERSIONS

Version	Date	Description
V1.0	09.01.2026	Initial Release
V1.1.	03.02.2026	Competiton Schedule

CONTENTS

1. COMPETITION PURPOSE	3
2. COMPETITION SCOPE	3
3. ACCESSIBILITY	3
4. APPLICATION RULES.....	4
5. COMPETITION SCHEDULE.....	4
6. WORLD DRONE CUP 2026 RULES	5
6.1. Schedule	5
6.2. Drone Features	5
6.3. Track	5
6.4. Unsportsmanlike conduct.....	6
6.5. Etiquette.....	6
6.6. VRx equipment.....	6
6.7. Reruns.....	7
6.8. Pratice and warm up.....	8
6.9. Qualifying	8
6.10. MAIN RACES	8
7. AWARDS	9
8. ETHICAL RULES	9
9. CONTACT	9

1. COMPETITION PURPOSE

TEKNOFEST is a festival full of innovation and science that brings technology enthusiasts together. It supports young people who shape the technologies of the future with many activities from drone races to artificial intelligence projects, from air shows to entrepreneurship summits. The festival also includes breathtaking air shows by world-famous aerobatic teams. Throughout the day, air shows and flight performances of military jets at close range will be presented to the audience. These demonstrations are carried out with high precision and discipline in the airspace.

The World Drone Cup competition will be held in Şanlıurfa on the same dates as this festival.

Location: Şanlıurfa, Türkiye

The World Drone Cup 2026 is an international competition that brings together racers from around the world to identify the most skilled drone pilots. It provides participants with the opportunity to showcase their technical skills and strategic expertise in a challenging race environment. Additionally, the competition aims to promote the advancement of drone technologies, encourage innovation, and contribute to the aviation community.

2. COMPETITION SCOPE

The competition consists of training days, qualification rounds, and final races. Pilots must navigate the designated track, passing obstacles in the correct order and in compliance with the rules, to achieve the fastest possible time. Since the race takes place at a partially active airport, participants must adapt to real-world conditions such as signal interference, high noise levels, and security restrictions. The organization ensures a fair racing environment by implementing various regulations, safety measures, and sportsmanship principles.

The flights will take place at a partially active airport with thousands of spectators, active smartphones, Wi-Fi networks and various public and military transmitters. In this busy environment, there is a possibility of occasional interruptions in data transmission and video streaming. In particular, due to high data traffic and frequency density, there may be temporary disruptions in audio-visual transmission.

3. ACCESSIBILITY

Transport and Accommodation

Transport and accommodation support will be provided to the contestants who are eligible to participate in the finals of the drone competition. After the application process is completed and the finalists are announced, a Google Form will be sent to your e- mail addresses registered in the CMS system, where you can report your transport requests.

Detailed information and addresses of the accommodation facilities will be shared with the participants before the competition date. All information about transport organisation and accommodation processes will be announced through official communication channels.

Shuttle Services

For the competitors determined as finalists, transfers to the accommodation facility and transport to the race area will be provided. Transport services between the accommodation facilities and the race venue will be organised in line with the competition schedule.

After the race days and times are determined, detailed information about the shuttle times and routes will be provided. All updates and announcements regarding the transfer services will be communicated to the participants through the official communication channels.

4. APPLICATION RULES

The World Drone Cup competition is open to international applications and only foreign drone competitors can apply. TEKNOFEST Drone championship degrees are awarded the right to compete in the World Drone Cup competition.

Applications will be received through the TEKNOFEST Aviation, Space and Technology Festival Technology Competitions official website (www.teknofest.org).

Applications are made online via the www.t3kys.com application system until 20.02.2026

The competitor will be able to participate in the competition by reading and approving all explanations about the competition and the conditions of participation before applying. For individual application, it is necessary to apply by creating a one-person team through the team creation module in the CMS portal

5. COMPETITION SCHEDULE

Date	Details
15.05.2026	Deadline for Competition application
17.07.2026	Announcement of application results
30 September- 4 October 2026	Final Stage/ TEKNOFEST Şanlıurfa

6. WORLD DRONE CUP 2026 RULES

6.1. Schedule

This competition may undergo short-term adjustments due to unforeseen circumstances, such as weather conditions, technical issues

Competition days for example;

- Thursday – Training Day

Thursday will be dedicated to training, allowing pilots to familiarize themselves with the track and environment, while we make adjustments to the race equipment.

- Friday – Qualifying Rounds

On Friday, we will begin with 1-2 warm-up laps to prepare for the race. The rest of the day will be dedicated to qualifying rounds, which will determine your starting position for the finals.

- Saturday – Finals

On Saturday, we will start with some warm-up laps to ensure smooth racing conditions. The day will then proceed with the finals, where the last 4 pilots will compete in a double-elimination bracket to crown the 2026 World Drone Cup Champion.

6.2. Drone Features

Framesize: 4" - 6" Batteries: up to 6s

LEDs (optional): 4 LEDs face back/down to be visible for following pilots Switchable colors would be preferred

25mW VTx, analog and HDZero only, needs to be controllable through your remote (i.e. if a drone crashes in an inaccessible location, switching on PitMode or to a trash channel).

It is forbidden to increase the output power with various offset values in addition to the specified output power. If detected, the competitor will be disqualified from that stage.

25mW Crossfire (Turkey is using 900MHz GSM, so set your Crossfire to 868MHz!) 25mW ELRS/Tracer/Ghost/2.4GHz and turn off dynamic power.

In 2019 pilots with "regular" 2.4GHz RC links had major issues/fail safes on this location!

6.3. Track

Obstacles have to be passed in the correct order and from the designated side. The travel between obstacles is up to the pilots.

6.4. Unsportsmanlike conduct

Any actions or behaviors that may prevent other pilots from performing at their best will be assessed by race officials, and appropriate warnings may be issued. Violations of the rules may result in warnings, penalties, or disqualification

Any form of insult, criminal act, discrimination, threats, or physical and psychological pressure will not be tolerated and will be subject to disciplinary actions.

6.5. Etiquette

The pilot's area will be equipped with a wooden floor. This might swing and give when people are walking. Therefore movement within or in close proximity to the active pilots area has to be limited to the absolute minimum. Personal spotter/helper and pilots have to stay in place until the very last pilot of the current race has ended his flight. Race leads might move for good reasons.

Communication between spotters/personal helpers and the pilot has to be non disturbing to other pilots.

“Objecting” has to be kept to a minimum. Race leads will take note and call out violations of others if necessary.

In case of video issues or failsafes, it's in the pilots responsibilities to judge over a safe flight. In case the safety is jeopardized the pilot has to land or “safely crash” his drone on the spot, not crossing the flying field to get to the designated landing zone. Discussions with race leads will be held AFTER all remaining pilots have landed/crashed.

No drones will be allowed to be operated in the waiting area. If you need to check your video transmission or test a repaired drone, you must come to the racing line and get permission from the officials. These checks can only be carried out while other pilots are setting up or collecting their drones.

Failure to comply with these rules may be considered a violation of the race rules and may result in a warning, penalty or disqualification. For the safety of all participants and the fairness of the race, these rules must be strictly followed.

6.6. VRx equipment

This year, pilots will not be provided with a centralised video transmission. All participants must use their own receivers to receive video signals. Supported systems are only Analogue and HDZero technologies.

As our flights will take place at a partially active aerodrome, there may be interruptions in video transmission due to various signal sources. All pilots are strongly advised to be prepared for this situation.

6.7. Reruns

Repeat races will take place at the earliest possible time and preferably before the current race is completed. However, this cannot be guaranteed and is subject to change depending on operational conditions.

The race stewards will make the final decision as to whether pilots who have previously crashed or caused an incident requiring a restart of the race will be allowed to take part in the race again. This judgement will be made to ensure that the race proceeds in a fair and safe manner.

Conditions for a restart

- Fire On The Track
- Collapsed Or Compromised Obstacles
- People On The Track Or Other Unsafe Conditions
- False Start
- Holeshoot Rule

False Start

Falling of the start block will be considered as a false start.

During qualifying:

In the event of a false start by a driver, the race will be cancelled for all drivers present and a warning will be given to the drivers concerned. A second false start in the same race will result in the first lap of the respective drivers being invalidated.

If a false start is not recognised by the race officials but is reported to the officials immediately after the race, the officials will review the DVR recordings and make a final decision. If it is determined that the pilot who made the false start took advantage of this situation, the first lap of the relevant pilot will be invalidated.

During finals

A false start will result in an abort and warning for all current pilots. A second false start will result in disqualification for that race.

If a false start is missed by the officials and the false start is brought to attention right after the race, the officials will review the DVR and make a decision. If the pilot that jumped the gun finishes in an advancing position, the other advancing pilot will keep his position. All non-advancing pilots and the pilot that jumped the gun will re race for the remaining advancing position.

Fly until the whistle blows

Pilots must continue to race unless one of the race leads or the timing system calls for landing. Calls from other pilots, spectators and others have to be ignored.

Holeshot rule

For races with a collective start (all pilots start at the same time) there will be a holeshot obstacle. Midairs that occur before the first passing of that obstacle will result in a rerun for all pilots. There will be only one restart per race. In case of midairs during the rerun the race will continue.

6.8. Practice and warm up

Practice and warm up heats will be handled like a Fastest-3-Consecutive run:

- Pilots will be grouped by random
- 2 minutes to fly as many laps as you can squeeze out of your batteries
- There is no claim for results/reruns in case timing system fails

6.9. Qualifying

Qualifying will be done by Fastest-3-Consecutive

Pilots will be randomly grouped. Race duration is 120 seconds. Goal is to fly your fastest 3 consecutive laps in a race. It is not mandatory to fly all 120 seconds and therefore damage your batteries. Timing for each pilot starts after the first pass of the timing gate.

These races will start staggered with a call out of the drone numbers.

If a pilot misses or incorrectly passes an obstacle, he must retake the obstacle, otherwise the lap will be invalid.

Your best fastest-3-consecutive result will be used for qualifying.

6.10. MAIN RACES

Finals

Based on the qualifying results pilots will be qualifying into groups of four. Finals mode will be double elimination with the best pilots per group advancing in the winners bracket and the two remaining pilots will drop into losers bracket or out of competition.

Final races will start on the tone. The whole procedure is:

Three tones in 1 second intervals Random delay of 1...5 second Single tone to start
beep_beep_beep_pause_beep

Finals are "first to x laps" where the amount of laps will be determined on the race weekend and adjusted to the track length.

In case a pilot missed an obstacle he must go back and pass the obstacle again. In case he doesn't re-approach, this lap will go on until he reaches the missed gate and passes it correctly.

If two or more pilots fail to complete the required laps, the pilot who completed the most laps is ranked higher. If pilots crash on the same lap, the pilot who passed the most gates

is ranked higher. If pilots crash at the same gate, the pilot who was closer to the next gate and fell further forward in the runway flow is ranked higher. The referees will make this assessment based on the current runway design and the location of the dropped devices. The final 4 pilots will end the event in a “chase the ace”. Winner is who gets two wins. The rest of the podium will be sorted by the combined positions of these races. Tiebreaker being Fastest-3-Consecutive times from qualifying.

Referees may change the running or add new rules according to the conditions of the environment.

7. AWARDS

Prizes will be awarded to the winners in the competition final. These prizes are listed in the table below.

Category	Prize Amount
First Place	₺150.000,00
Second Place	₺120.000,00
Third Place	₺100.000,00

8. ETHICAL RULES

[Follow the link](#) for Ethical Rules of the Competition.

9. CONTACT

Questions regarding the organisational aspects of the competition should be sent via info@pilotevent.com or iletisim@teknofest.org e-mail address.

It is important to send your questions through the correct channels above in order to respond quickly to the questions asked.

Liability Disclaimer

The T3 Foundation and TEKNOFEST are not responsible for any injury or damage caused by any product submitted or actions taken by competitors. The foundation and event organizers are also not liable for damages caused by competitors to third parties.

Furthermore, the T3 Foundation and TEKNOFEST are not responsible for ensuring that teams prepare and implement their systems in compliance with the laws of the Republic of Türkiye.

Turkish Technology Team Foundation reserves the right to make any changes in this specification.



TEKNOFEST

AEROSPACE AND TECHNOLOGY FESTIVAL